

need to do that because of the Cell Processor taking on a large amount of the graphics processing responsibilities.

The chip was ready quickly, running at a core clock of 550 MHz and utilising 256 MB of video memory. Nvidia and Sony often touted the power of the RSX by saying it was more powerful than two GeForce 6800 Ultra graphics cards combined.

The RSX can easily output resolutions of up to 1080p; but an important feature is its upscaling ability. When you put in a regular DVD or VCD, the PS3 uses the incoming video data to send the information to the RSX, which refines the image quality when playing it back. For multimedia lovers and especially fans of old Hindi movies, this is a godsend!

With the 256 MB of memory here and the 256 MB of dedicated memory on board the PS3, the RAM is pretty much the only part of the console that is a downer in an otherwise magnificent hardware setup.

Blu-Ray ROM

The PlayStation 3 was also to introduce Sony's new format for optical disks, dubbed Blu-Ray. By now, the war between Sony's Blu-Ray and Toshiba's HD-DVD is long over with the former emerging triumphant, but at the time of the PS3's launch, it was a big deal indeed!



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Why would a Blu-Ray ROM affect release dates of games? Well, a large portion of developing a video game is in figuring out how to fit millions of lines of programming into the tiny 4.5-9 GB DVDs that are currently available. If a disk allowed programmers to not go through the shrinkage process, the ability to release a game becomes that much faster.

Hard Disk

The PS3 comes with different-sized hard disks, ranging from 20 GB right up to 80 GB. The coolest part about the PS3 is that it uses a standard 2.5-inch SATA hard disk. This means that as long as you find a model that is compatible with the PS3,